

September 21st LeaderCoach Test Feedback

Hi Biplob,

Thank you for the work you and your team have been doing. Here is feedback I pray you find helpful and something to move us closer to what can work.

I tested Jess again this morning using the same opening statement we used previously:

“My boss thinks I’m lazy.”

I want to pause before you make additional changes because I think there is an important distinction we need to make sure we all understand.

Jess is still responding primarily as an **answer/advice assistant rather than as a coach.**

Her first response was:

“It’s tough to hear that your boss has this perception of you. Addressing this directly can help improve the situation. Have you considered having a conversation with your boss to understand why they feel this way and to clarify any misunderstandings?”

The first sentence is good. But after that, Jess has already decided what the problem is and begun suggesting a solution.

At this point in the conversation, Jess actually knows very little.

She does not know whether the boss has said the user is lazy. She does not know what the user has observed. She does not know what the user may be interpreting. She does not know what the relationship with the boss is like, what has happened previously, what the user has already tried, or even yet what kind of help the user wants.

So Jess does not yet know enough to solve the problem.

This is a critical distinction in LeaderCoach.

Coaching is not primarily giving good advice. Coaching is a developing conversation in which Jess first helps the user understand and see their situation more clearly. Only when sufficient understanding has developed should Jess begin helping the user consider possibilities, choices, or actions.

For example, after:

User: “My boss thinks I’m lazy.”

A more appropriate response might be:

Jess: “It’s tough to feel your boss thinks that way. Tell me a little more about what’s happening that leaves you feeling your boss thinks you’re lazy.”

I am **not asking you to hard-code that question.** The exact wording is not the important part.

September 21st LeaderCoach Test Feedback

The important requirement is that Jess recognizes: **I do not yet understand enough to recommend what this person should do. I need to learn more.**

Then, after each meaningful response from the user, Jess should update what she understands and decide what kind of coaching move is most useful next.

For example, the conversation might reveal:

User: "She talks with the other people on the team but hardly talks with me."

That gives Jess new information to explore.

Later the user might say:

User: "She hasn't actually said I'm lazy. I just get the feeling she thinks that."

Now something important has been discovered. What initially sounded like a fact—"My boss thinks I'm lazy"—may actually be the user's interpretation of what they have observed.

Jess has helped the user discover that rather than telling the user what to do.

Eventually the conversation may appropriately reach questions such as "What have you tried?" or begin exploring whether talking with the boss would be useful. But **the conversation needs to earn its way there.**

This is why the changes we previously discussed around working understanding, what Jess knows and does not know, held observations, and choosing the next useful coaching move are so important.

Before you and your team make further changes, I would like you to help me understand how the current system is working:

How does Jess currently determine whether she should remain in discovery and learn more, versus when enough understanding has developed to move toward reflection, possibilities, advice, or action?

I am not looking for a list of better coaching questions. I want to make sure we agree on the underlying problem first. Once we do, we can determine together how best to make the system behave accordingly.

I appreciate the work you and the team have put into LeaderCoach. I believe getting this distinction right is essential to what makes LeaderCoach different from a good AI answer assistant.

**Thanks,
Larry**